

Chain-Branded Hotel

Hospitality · Full-service hotel
Downtown Detroit, Michigan · Franchise flag
Franchise-flag · full-service property (anonymized)



PREPARED BY

Kobra™

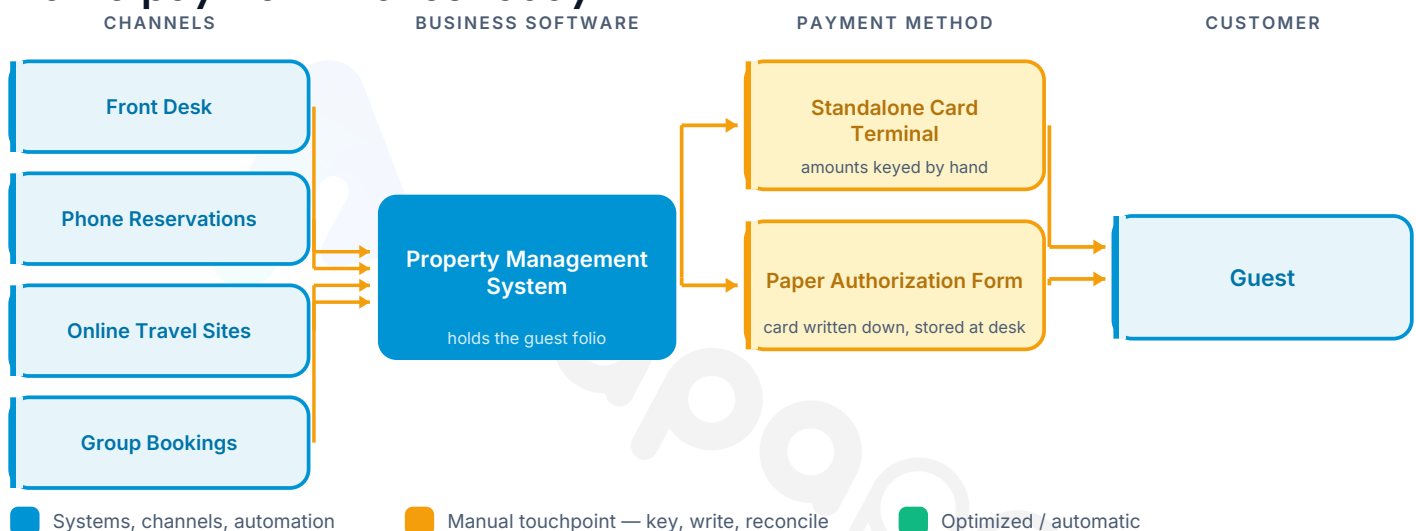
Business Payment Consultant

Reviewed by NapaPay · July 8, 2026

For Chain-Branded Hotel, we reviewed how payments currently move through your business. The purpose of this review is not to recommend changing providers. Its purpose is to visualize today's payment operation, identify manual work, explain why it matters, and highlight opportunities to simplify how payments move through your property.

CURRENT PAYMENT FLOW

How a payment moves today



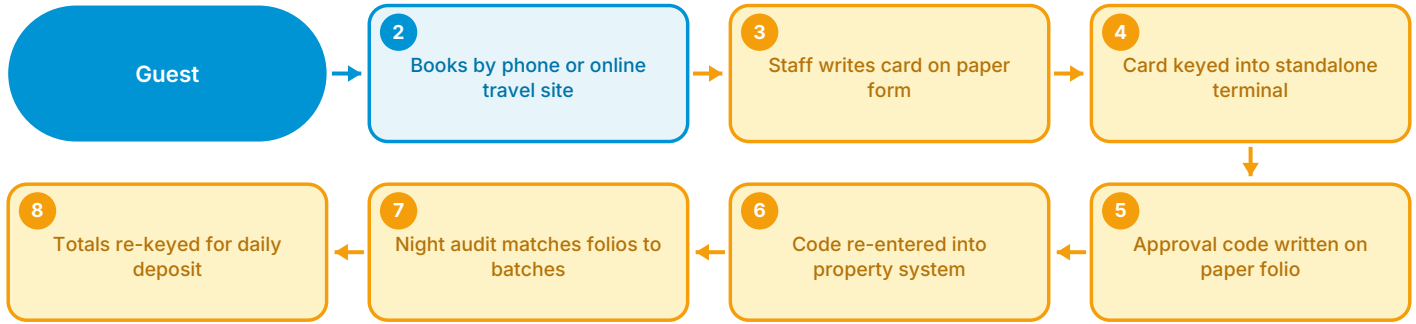
CURRENT OPERATIONAL HEALTH

Ten areas, at a glance

- | | |
|---|---|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Manual Processing
Front-desk and night-audit staff key card amounts into a terminal by hand for most payments. Payment Visibility
Card activity is only fully visible the next morning, once night audit reconciles the day. Reconciliation
Night audit spends significant time each night matching folios against terminal batches by hand. Customer Experience
Guests read card numbers over the phone or sign a paper form rather than paying securely themselves. Chargeback Protection
Advance and remote bookings are not authenticated at payment, so disputes are difficult to defend. | <ul style="list-style-type: none"> Automation
Card capture, folio posting, and reconciliation are all handled step-by-step by staff. Fraud Exposure
Card details live on paper in the front-desk area, widening the property's exposure. Remote Payments
Deposits, group blocks, and no-show fees are captured manually rather than through a secure link. Reporting
Daily numbers are rebuilt from terminal batches instead of appearing automatically. Accounting Integration
Approval codes are re-entered into the folio and totals are re-keyed for daily deposit. |
|---|---|

CURRENT WORKFLOW

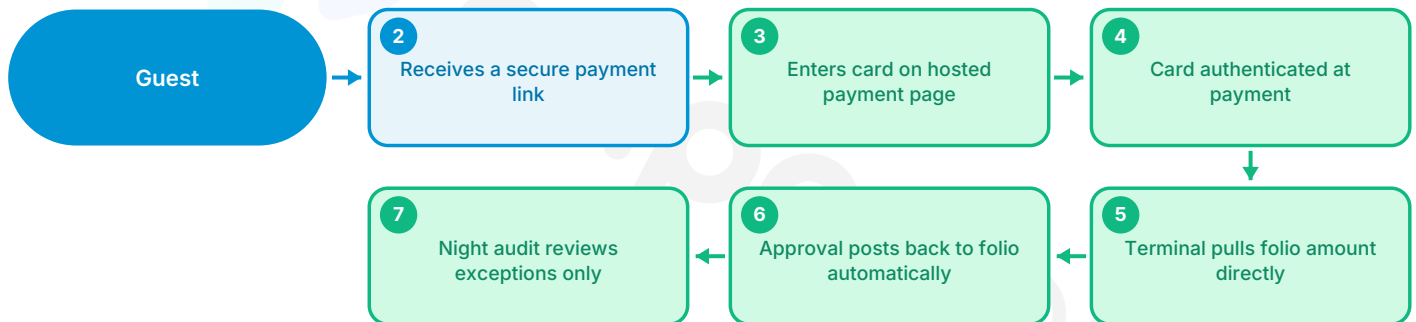
Today, step by step



When a guest books by phone or through an online travel site, a staff member writes the card details on a paper authorization form and keys the amount into a standalone terminal, often on a later shift. The approval code is written onto the paper folio and then typed back into the property management system by hand. Each night, audit staff reconcile every folio against the terminal batch and re-key the totals so the daily deposit and accounting numbers line up. The card touches paper, a person, and a keyboard at least twice before it ever reaches the bank.

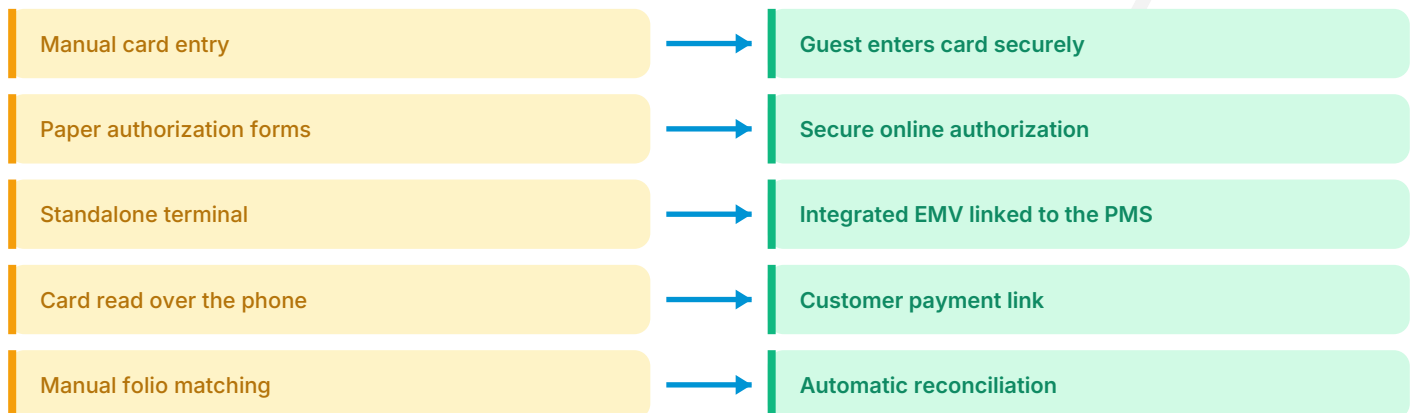
OPTIMIZED WORKFLOW

The same business, simplified



WORKFLOW COMPARISON

What changes, in plain terms



OPERATIONAL FINDINGS

What we observed

1 Remote bookings captured on paper

CURRENT SITUATION

Phone and online-travel reservations are captured on a paper authorization form, and the card is later keyed into a standalone terminal by front-desk staff. The paper is stored under the front desk.

WHY IT MATTERS

Card details sitting on paper in the front-desk area widen the property's exposure, and every hand-keyed card adds staff handling. Because the guest is never securely verified, disputed remote payments are hard to defend.

SUGGESTED IMPROVEMENT

Secure Payment Link

Guests authorize their own card on a hosted page before arrival.

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Instead of writing a card on a paper form and keying it in later, the guest securely authorizes the payment themselves from their own phone before they arrive.

INDUSTRY PERSPECTIVE

Across the payment industry, hosted payment pages are used so the card is entered directly by the cardholder and never handled by staff, which generally reduces the risk that comes with storing card details on paper. Because the cardholder is present and verified at the moment of payment, these transactions often receive more favorable handling under published card-network programs than manually keyed payments, depending on the processor agreement.

2 Card terminals not connected to the property system

CURRENT SITUATION

Standalone terminals at the front desk and food-and-beverage outlets require staff to read the amount off the folio screen and key it in. Approval codes are written on paper and re-entered into the property system afterward.

WHY IT MATTERS

Keying the same amount twice invites errors that only surface during night audit, sometimes the next morning. Duplicate charges and missed postings happen routinely and take staff time to unwind, and group folios take far longer to close.

SUGGESTED IMPROVEMENT

Integrated PMS Payments

EMV terminals connected to the property management system.

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Instead of reading the amount off the folio screen and keying it into a separate terminal, the terminal pulls the amount directly and posts the approval back on its own.

INDUSTRY PERSPECTIVE

Integration is used across the payment industry primarily to reduce labour by eliminating duplicate data entry while improving reporting accuracy and reconciliation. Properly processed EMV chip transactions generally represent lower fraud risk than manually keyed transactions and often receive more favorable interchange treatment under published card-network programs, with final pricing depending on the processor agreement.

3 Remote payments carry all the dispute risk

CURRENT SITUATION

A meaningful share of revenue arrives remotely — advance deposits, group blocks, no-show fees, and incidental holds — and none of it is verified when the booking is made.

WHY IT MATTERS

Every remote-payment dispute currently lands on the property to defend, and without cardholder verification these are very difficult to win. Group cancellation disputes and the staff time spent gathering paperwork to fight them add up.

SUGGESTED IMPROVEMENT

3-D Secure (3DS2)

Cardholder authentication on advance and remote bookings.

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Instead of the property absorbing every remote-booking dispute, the guest is verified when the booking is made, leaving a clean record to stand behind.

INDUSTRY PERSPECTIVE

3-D Secure authenticates the customer during a remote payment, and authenticated transactions generally present lower fraud risk. Depending on the card brand and transaction type, these payments may qualify for different interchange treatment while shifting liability for many fraud-related disputes away from the merchant — a program card networks make available industry-wide.

4 International guests get no currency choice

CURRENT SITUATION

The property serves a meaningful international guest mix, but foreign cards are processed in Canadian dollars only. Guests are not offered the option to see and pay in their own currency at checkout.

WHY IT MATTERS

Foreign guests see an unpredictable exchange rate on their statement days later, and some loyalty guests would prefer to see the charge in their home currency at the moment of payment. No choice is offered anywhere in the current checkout.

SUGGESTED IMPROVEMENT

Dynamic Currency Conversion

Optional home-currency choice offered at checkout.

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PLAIN ENGLISH

Instead of a foreign guest discovering an unpredictable exchange rate days later, they can choose to see and pay in their own currency at the moment of payment — or decline it.

INDUSTRY PERSPECTIVE

Businesses serving international customers sometimes offer payment in the customer's home currency. Participation is always optional for the cardholder and may improve payment transparency for international visitors, though eligibility generally depends on the card issuer and the transaction type.

IMPROVEMENT OPPORTUNITIES

Six places to simplify



Reduce manual entry

Let guests enter their own card and let terminals pull the folio amount directly. The same figure stops being typed two and three times across a stay.



Improve payment visibility

See card activity as it happens instead of rebuilding it the next morning. The team knows where the day stands without waiting for night audit.



Simplify reconciliation

When approvals post back to the folio automatically, night audit reviews exceptions rather than re-keying every line. Hours come back to the overnight shift.



Reduce fraud exposure

A hosted payment page keeps card details off paper and out of the front-desk drawer. Verified payments are far easier to stand behind if a dispute arrives.



Improve the guest payment experience

A secure link lets guests pay from their phone before arrival — no card read aloud, no paper form. International guests can be offered a currency choice at checkout.



Improve the accounting workflow

Approvals and totals flow from the folio to the daily deposit on their own. The path from card capture to accounting stops depending on manual re-keying.

SUMMARY & NEXT STEPS

A note on this review

This review summarizes our understanding of your payment operation. It is intended to begin a conversation, not recommend changing providers. If anything does not accurately reflect your business, we encourage you to let us know — every business is different, and this review is a starting point for discussion.

QUESTIONS WORTH DISCUSSING

Worth raising with your current provider

- Could remote and advance bookings require fewer manual steps at the front desk?
- Could guests securely authorize their own payment instead of reading a card over the phone?
- Could night audit spend less time matching folios to terminal batches?
- Could approvals post back to the guest folio automatically?
- Could international guests be offered a currency choice at checkout?
- Could your current provider already support some of these improvements?

PREPARED & REVIEWED BY

Your payment consulting team



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Powered by NapaPay

An educational, vendor-neutral operational review.



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